

Endocrinology Service Line Handbook

Meridian Health Partners

Department: Endocrinology Service Line

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Approval: Meridian Health Partners Clinical Operations Board

1.0 Purpose

1.1 This handbook standardizes the operational procedures and patient management guidelines for the Endocrinology service line across all 14 Meridian Health Partners outpatient clinics.

1.2 It ensures consistent service delivery, patient preparation, and clear communication regarding scope of practice and financial coverage.

2.0 Scope of Practice: Accepted Conditions

2.1 The Meridian Health Partners Endocrinology service line accepts referrals for the following conditions:

2.1.1 Type 1 and Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus, including newly diagnosed, poorly controlled, insulin pump management, and advanced glucose monitoring.

2.1.2 Thyroid disorders, including hypothyroidism, hyperthyroidism (Graves' disease, toxic nodular goiter), thyroid nodules, and goiter.

2.1.3 Osteoporosis and other metabolic bone diseases (e.g., Paget's disease, osteomalacia).

2.1.4 Adrenal disorders, including adrenal insufficiency (Addison's disease), adrenal adenomas, and hyperaldosteronism.

2.1.5 Pituitary disorders, including pituitary adenomas (prolactinoma, acromegaly, Cushing's disease), and hypopituitarism.

2.1.6 Polycystic Ovary Syndrome (PCOS).

2.1.7 Parathyroid disorders, including primary and secondary hyperparathyroidism, and hypoparathyroidism.

2.1.8 Hypogonadism in both male and female patients.

3.0 Scope of Practice: Excluded Conditions

3.1 The Meridian Health Partners Endocrinology service line does not accept referrals for the following conditions or services:

3.1.1 Pediatric endocrinology: Patients under 18 years of age must be referred to Meridian Children's Hospital Endocrinology Department.

3.1.2 Acute diabetic emergencies: Conditions such as Diabetic Ketoacidosis (DKA) or Hyperosmolar Hyperglycemic State (HHS) require immediate care at an Urgent Care facility or Emergency Department.

3.1.3 Bariatric surgery evaluation: Referrals for bariatric surgical clearance or post-surgical metabolic management should be directed to the General Surgery – Metabolic & Bariatric Program.

3.1.4 Gender-affirming hormone therapy initiation: Patients seeking initiation of gender-affirming hormone therapy should be referred to Meridian LGBTQ+ Health Services.

3.1.5 Infertility management not directly related to endocrine dysfunction: For primary infertility investigations where endocrine causes have been ruled out, refer to external Reproductive Endocrinology & Infertility specialists.

4.0 Typical Appointment Duration

4.1 New Patient Consultations are allocated 60 minutes.

4.2 Follow-up Appointments are allocated 30 minutes.

4.3 Complex Procedure Consultations, such as initial insulin pump starts or advanced continuous glucose monitor (CGM) training, are allocated 90 minutes.

5.0 Patient Preparation Instructions

5.1 Patients scheduled for an endocrinology appointment will receive the following instructions:

5.1.1 Fasting Requirements: Patients must confirm with the scheduling team if their appointment

requires fasting. If required, patients must fast for 8-12 hours prior to their appointment, consuming only water.

5.1.2 Medication List: Patients must bring an accurate and up-to-date list of all current prescription medications, over-the-counter drugs, supplements, and their respective dosages and frequencies.

5.1.3 Prior Medical Records: If the patient has been seen by another endocrinologist or relevant specialist outside the Meridian Health Partners network, they are instructed to bring copies of their most recent visit notes and lab results, or to arrange for their forwarding prior to the appointment.

5.1.4 Glucose Logs (for Diabetes Patients): Diabetes patients are required to bring a minimum of 7 days of their most recent blood glucose readings, whether from a logbook, meter download, or CGM data.

6.0 Meridian Health Partners Plan Coverage for Endocrinology Procedures

6.1 The following outlines coverage for selected common endocrinology procedures across the four Meridian Health Partners insurance plans.

6.1.1 Thyroid Ultrasound & Biopsy (Fine Needle Aspiration):

6.1.1.1 Meridian Standard: Not covered.

6.1.1.2 Meridian Plus: Covered, subject to 20% co-insurance.

6.1.1.3 Meridian Premium: Covered, subject to a \$50 co-pay.

6.1.1.4 Meridian Executive: Covered, no co-pay.

6.1.2 DEXA Scan (Bone Density Measurement):

6.1.2.1 Meridian Standard: Covered, subject to 30% co-insurance.

6.1.2.2 Meridian Plus: Covered, subject to 15% co-insurance.

6.1.2.3 Meridian Premium: Covered, subject to a \$30 co-pay.

6.1.2.4 Meridian Executive: Covered, no co-pay.

6.1.3 Continuous Glucose Monitor (CGM) Initiation & Training:

6.1.3.1 Meridian Standard: Not covered.

6.1.3.2 Meridian Plus: Covered, subject to a \$75 co-pay for the training session.

6.1.3.3 Meridian Premium: Covered, subject to a \$25 co-pay for the training session.

6.1.3.4 Meridian Executive: Covered, no co-pay.

6.1.4 Adrenal Vein Sampling (AVS) Coordination: (Note: This procedure is performed at an external imaging center, Meridian provides coordination only.)

6.1.4.1 Meridian Standard: Not covered.

6.1.4.2 Meridian Plus: Not covered.

6.1.4.3 Meridian Premium: Covered, subject to 15% co-insurance for Meridian-coordinated aspects.

6.1.4.4 Meridian Executive: Covered, no co-pay for Meridian-coordinated aspects.

7.0 Referral Turnaround Commitment

7.1 All internal Meridian Health Partners referrals received by 16:00 (4 PM) on a business day will be reviewed and triaged by an Endocrinology team member within 2 business days.

7.2 External referrals, requiring manual data entry by the central referral intake team, will be reviewed within 3 business days of their receipt by that team.

7.3 Urgent referrals, as specifically flagged by the referring provider via the EHR system (MeridianNet), will be reviewed within 24 hours of receipt.